

Ditch The Sheet

Senior Design Team Contract

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Intent

The following contract was written and agreed upon by Nathan Voegel, Trinity Dozier, Evan Velasquez, and Matthew Abbott. The contract provides expectations, objectives, and results for developing the **Ditch the Sheet.**

The contract is effective for all team members participating in the Senior Design Capstone class series in the 2026-2027 academic year.

Senior Design Contract

Project Summary

The **Ditch the Sheet** is an application designed to help university students manage their internship and co-op search processes more effectively. The system will centralize application tracking, deadlines, recruiter communication, and interview scheduling into a single platform. By improving organization and visibility, the application aims to reduce missed opportunities and streamline the internship search experience.

Problem Statement

Many university students apply to multiple internships or co-op positions while also managing academic responsibilities, work schedules, and extracurricular commitments. This often requires students to track deadlines, interview dates, recruiter communications, and application statuses across multiple platforms such as Handshake, LinkedIn, email, spreadsheets, and personal notes.

Internship experience has become a critical factor in the job search process, as employers frequently prioritize candidates with relevant experience and offer them more opportunities and higher starting salaries (National Association of Colleges and Employers [NACE], 2024). At the same time, many students face significant barriers during the internship search, including limited time due to academic workloads, financial concerns, and lack of available opportunities (NACE, 2024).

In addition, the internship search process itself can be complex and difficult to navigate. Only a small percentage of students report that finding an internship is easy, and many face unclear job requirements, multiple application steps, and stressful assessments (Institute of Student Employers [ISE], 2025). As a result, students often apply to multiple positions simultaneously, requiring them to manage different deadlines, requirements, and communication channels.

The application process is also frequently described as time-consuming and exhausting, with students applying to dozens of positions while receiving limited responses, leading to frustration and burnout (LA-Tech.org, 2023). Managing this process across multiple disconnected systems can increase the likelihood of missed deadlines, inconsistent follow-up, and disorganization.

As a result, qualified students may lose opportunities because of disorganization rather than lack of ability. A centralized tracking solution is needed to improve how students manage the co-op search process.

Solution

The Job Snob will provide a centralized dashboard that allows students to organize and monitor all aspects of their internship search in one place.

Core features will include:

- Application status tracking
- Deadline reminders
- Recruiters contact management
- Interview scheduling and notes
- Search history and progress visibility

These features are designed to directly address common student challenges by providing tools that improve organization and simplify the application process. For example, deadline reminders help prevent missed opportunities, while a centralized dashboard allows students to keep all applications in one place. Recruiters' contact management and interview notes support better follow-up and preparation, and status tracking helps users manage multiple opportunities more effectively.

Contact Information

TEAM MEMBER	DEGREE + TRACK TRACK N/A FOR BSCYBER	EMAIL	PHONE NUMBER OR OTHER CONTACT INFO
Dozier Trinity	BSIT - Data	Doziertc@mail.uc.edu	
Evan Velasquez	BSIT - Networking and Systems	velasgen@mail.uc.edu	630-797-1760
Nathan Voegele	BSIT - Data	Voegelnh@mail.uc.edu	(513) 330-4853
Matt Abbott	BSIT – Software Development	Abbottmh@mail.uc.edu	(859)653-6471

Sponsor Information (if applicable)

NAME	COMPANY	TITLE	EMAIL
N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A

Project Source

The idea for the Job Snob was inspired by the personal experiences of the project team members. Many of us have struggled to keep track of multiple co-op applications, deadlines, and recruiter communications across different platforms such as Handshake, LinkedIn, and email.

The requirements were analyzed collaboratively by the team through discussion of common challenges faced during the co-op search process. The team was formed through the Senior Design course and shares a common goal of improving the student job search experience.

Project Objectives/Goals

- Develop a centralized platform for managing internship and co-op applications
- Provide a dashboard capable of tracking multiple applications per user
- Implement application status tracking (Applied, Interviewing, Offer, Rejected)
- Include automated reminders for deadlines and important events
- Allow users to store recruiter contact information and communication notes
- Develop a working prototype during the initial phase of the project
- Deliver a fully functional application by the end of the academic year
- Conduct testing and refinement during the final phase of development
- Present a completed and functional system as the final deliverable

Team Members and Responsibilities

Matt Abbott

- Assists with front-end development (e.g., implementing UI components, ensuring responsiveness).
- Develops backend features (e.g., API endpoints for application tracking, recruiter management).
- Implements automated reminders (e.g., email or in-app notifications for deadlines).
- Conducts testing and debugging for both frontend and backend components.

Evan Velasquez

- Develops server-side logic and APIs for the application.
- Implements user authentication (login and account management).
- Manages the database (e.g., storing application data, recruiter contacts, and interview notes).
- Ensures scalability and performance of the backend.
- Integrates features like deadline tracking and automated reminders.

Nathan Voegelé

- Conducts research on user needs and industry standards for co-op application tracking.
- Ensures data accuracy and integrity in the application.
- Designs data models for storing application statuses, recruiter contacts, and interview notes.
- Generates reports and visualizations (e.g., progress dashboards, application statistics).

Trinity Dozier

- Oversees the entire project timeline and ensures deadlines are met.
- Coordinates team meetings and communication.
- Designs the **user interface (UI)** and **user experience (UX)** for the web application.
- Ensures the project aligns with academic and ethical standards.
- Collaborates with the backend team to integrate frontend and backend components.

Project Scope

Our team will develop a functional web-based application that enables students to manage and track their co-op applications efficiently. The system will provide a centralized solution for organizing job search data and improving overall productivity.

The project will be completed in multiple phases across the academic year, including planning, design, development, testing, and deployment.

Core Features

- User authentication (login and account management)
- Dashboard displaying all applications
- Ability to add, edit, and delete applications
- Application status tracking
- Deadline tracking and reminders
- Recruiter contact management
- Interview tracking and notes

Quick Project Timeline

[A rough estimate of your project timeline in a tabular format with the following fields:

Task #	Task Name	Duration	Start Date	End Date
Task 1	Draft Contract	2 Weeks	8/31/2026	9/21/2026
Task 2	Research Functionality	3 Weeks	9/21/2026	10/05/2026
Task 3	Wire Frame and UI Design Concept	2 Weeks	10/5/2026	10/19/2026
Task 4	Presentation Prep	1 Week	10/19/2026	10/26/2026
Task 5	Build Product	14 Weeks	January	April

Technologies Used

[A brief description of technologies you intend to use for the development and implementation of your solution.]

- VSCode

- *GitHub*

Ethical and Legal Considerations

Because the Better Co-op Application Tracker stores personal and professional information related to a student's internship or co-op search, the project needs to consider ethical, legal, and security responsibilities. The system may store application history, company names, recruiter contact information, interview dates, follow-up notes, and user account credentials. If this information is not handled properly, users could experience privacy issues, unauthorized access to their data, or a loss of trust in the system.

Privacy and Data Protection Responsibilities

One of the main responsibilities of this project is protecting user privacy. The system should only collect information that is necessary for tracking applications. Since it stores recruiter details, interview notes, and application history, the team needs to make sure that user data is handled carefully and that users have control over their own information.

Some specific risks include exposing a student's job search activity, revealing recruiter contact information, or keeping personal notes longer than necessary. These situations create both ethical and legal concerns when it comes to handling user data. Principles such as data minimization and giving users control over their personal information are emphasized in the General Data Protection Regulation (European Union, 2016).

Countermeasures:

- *Store only the information needed for the application to function*
- *Allow users to edit or delete their records at any time*
- *Clearly explain what data is being collected and why*
- *Restrict access so users can only view their own data*
- *Do not share or sell user data to third parties*

Security Responsibilities

Since this is a web-based application, it must also address common security risks. Web applications are often vulnerable to issues like SQL injection, broken authentication, and unauthorized access (OWASP Foundation, 2024). For this project, these risks could mean someone gaining access to another user's application data or entering harmful input into the system.

The team has a responsibility to build the system in a way that protects user data and prevents these types of issues. Following established security practices helps reduce these risks and ensures the system is developed responsibly. The NIST Cybersecurity Framework focuses on managing security risks through system protection, access control, and monitoring (National Institute of Standards and Technology [NIST], 2018).

Countermeasures:

- *Use secure authentication to protect user accounts*
- *Hash passwords instead of storing them in plain text*
- *Use parameterized queries to prevent SQL injection*
- *Validate and sanitize all user input*
- *Apply access controls to prevent unauthorized access*
- *Test the system for security issues during development*

Transparency

The application will not sell or share user data with third parties. Users should understand what information is being stored and how it is used so they can feel confident using the system. Giving users control over their data and being clear about how it is handled supports trust and aligns with data protection principles (European Union, 2016).

Team Rules

1. Plagiarism will not be tolerated.
2. All team members will complete assigned tasks on time.
3. Communication is required.
4. Respect and collaboration will be maintained at all times.
5. All members will contribute equally to the success of the project.

Team Signatures:

Signature: Nathan Voegele

Signature: Evan Velasquez

Date: 9/14/2026

Date: 09/21/26

Signature: Trinity Dozier

Signature: Matthew Abbott

Date: 9-14-2026

Date: 9-21-2026

Advisor Signature:

Signature: Jason Gerst

Date: 9-21-2026

References

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